

Hitter_w_Plots

Introduction

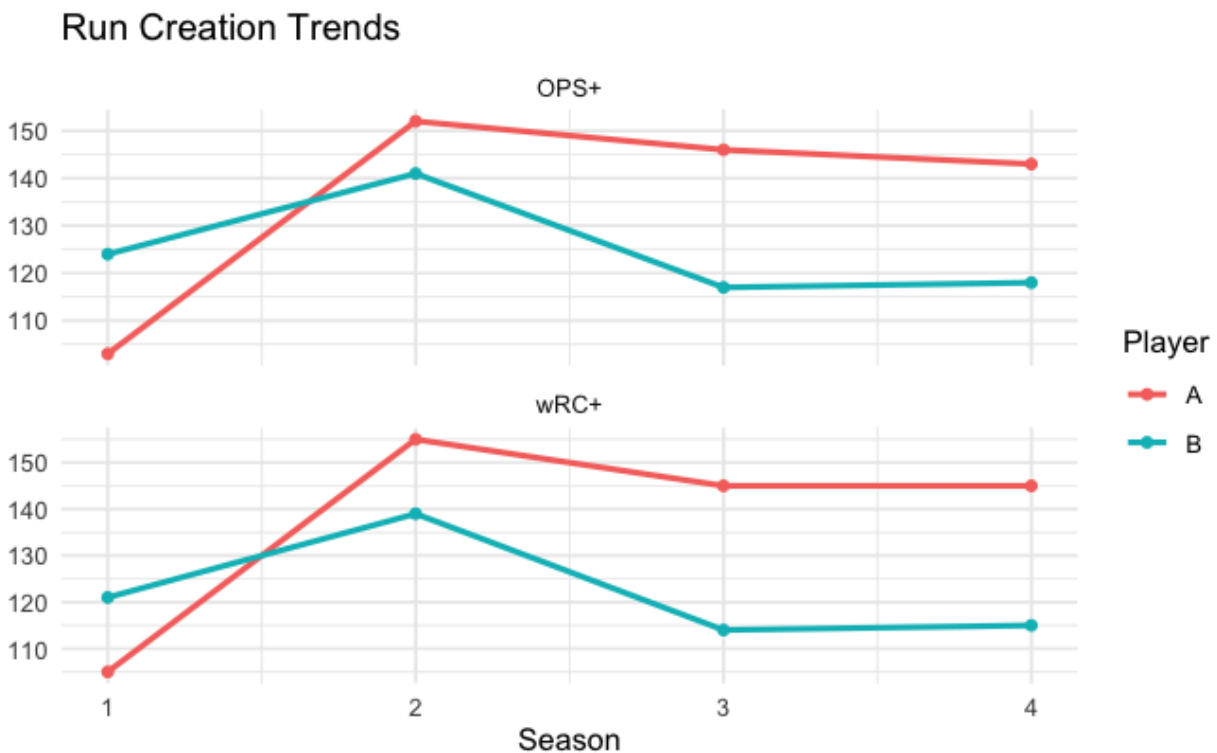
The organization faces an important decision in filling a vacant roster spot, and I have been asked to evaluate two candidates, Player A and Player B. Both bring proven track records, but their profiles diverge. Player A is entering his prime years, and combines strong offensive consistency with plus defensive metrics at first base. Player B is a veteran with a solid batting line, who offers offensive value but carries defensive limitations and age-related concerns. My analysis weighs offensive, defensive, and overall contributions to recommend the best fit for the roster vacancy.

Offensive Comparison

Both players have shown power and run production. Player A hit 118 home runs and drove in 368 runs over the past four seasons, while Player B hit 113 with 403 RBI. The RBI edge leans toward Player B, but context matters. Player A's higher on-base percentage (.370 vs .341), fueled by nearly double the walks (301 vs 155), translates to superior OPS+ (136 vs 125) and wRC+ (137 vs 123).

Figure 1 (Run Creation Trends) illustrates this consistency, showing Player A with higher OPS+ and wRC+ in most seasons. Plate discipline further separates them: Player A struck out less often and walked nearly twice as much, a sustainable profile that outweighs Player B's higher batting average (.288 vs .271).

Figure 1 (Run Creation Trends)

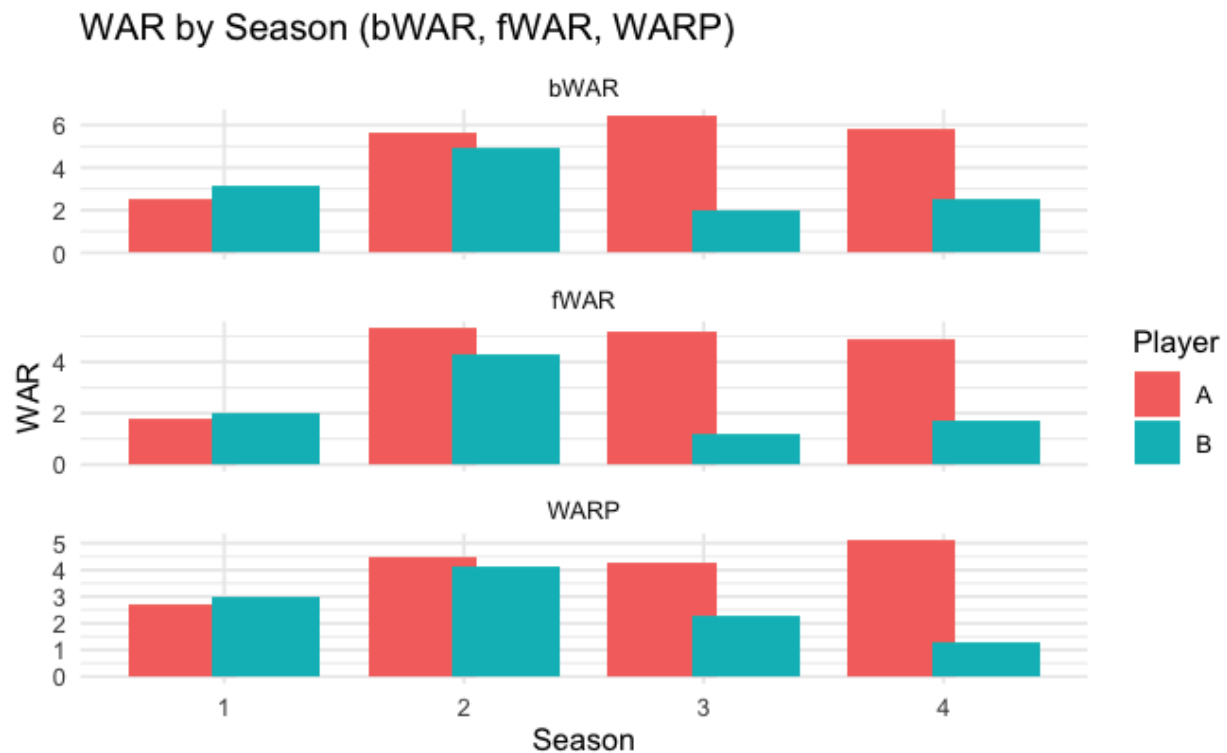


Advanced Metrics

Player A's advantage is clear in overall value. Across four seasons, he accumulated 17.2 fWAR and 20.3 bWAR, nearly double Player B's 9.2 fWAR and 12.5 bWAR. WARP shows a similar gap (16.6 vs 10.7).

As shown in **Figure 2 (WAR by Season)**, Player A consistently outpaces Player B across all three WAR frameworks. This not only highlights the cumulative gap but also demonstrates Player A's balance of offensive and defensive impact.

Figure 2 (WAR by Season)

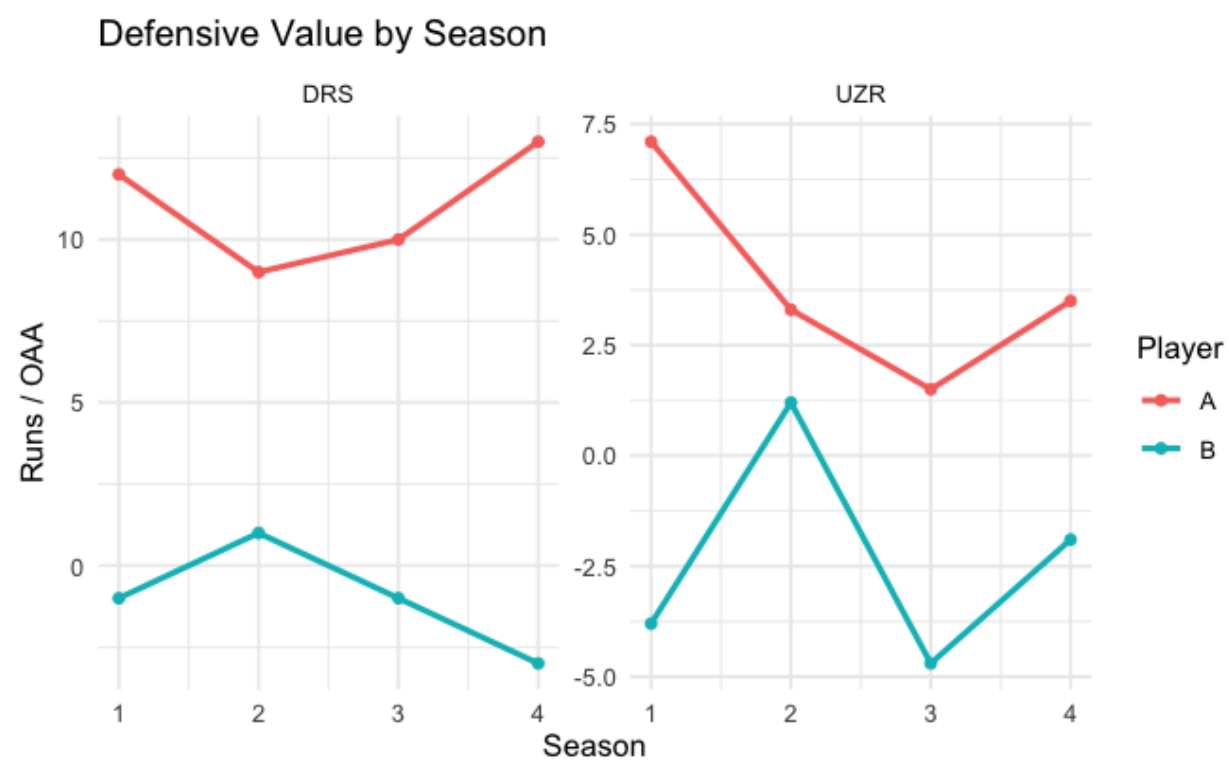


Defensive Comparison

First base is often viewed as a bat-first position, but defense should not be dismissed. Here, the difference is decisive. Player A posted +15.4 UZR and +44 DRS over four seasons, while Player B recorded -9.2 UZR and -4 DRS.

Figure 3 (Defensive Value by Season) makes the contrast clear: Player A saves runs while Player B costs them. Player B's increasing time at designated hitter further limits his utility, while Player A provides steady defense that stabilizes the infield.

Figure 3 (Defensive Value by Season)



Age and Trajectory

The stage of their is also critical. Player A's four-year sample covers ages 23–26, his early prime. With his best years still ahead, he projects to sustain or even improve production. Player B's sample covers ages 29–32, with defense already fading. For both short- and long-term planning, Player A is the better bet.

Recommendation

Both players bring durability and offensive skills, but Player A separates himself through superior on-base ability, higher WAR totals, and clear defensive value. Combined with his age advantage, he offers the more complete package.

Therefore, the team should select Player A to fill the open roster spot. He provides reliable offense, strengthens the defense, and projects as a sustainable contributor. In a choice between

a younger two-way player entering his prime and an older, bat-first veteran with defensive liabilities, the long-term upside and balanced value clearly favor Player A.

Pitcher_w_Plots

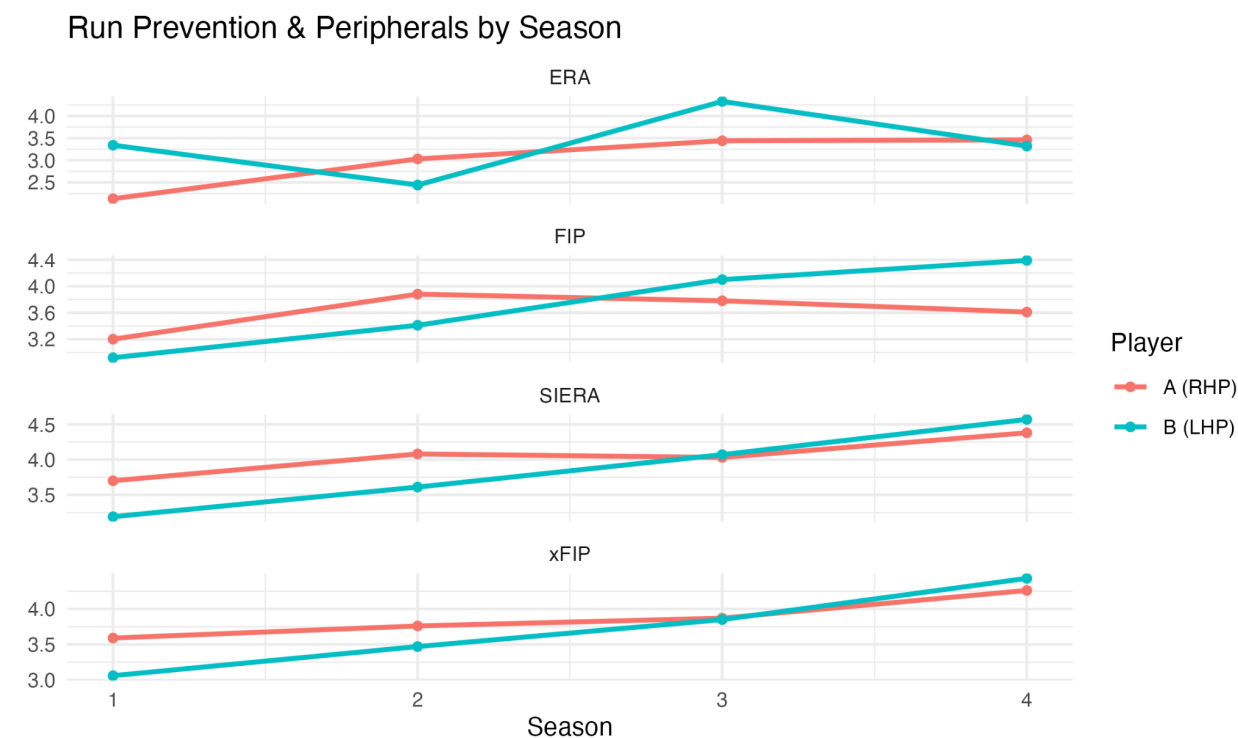
Introduction

The organization must decide between two rotation candidates: Pitcher A, a right-hander in his late twenties, and Pitcher B, a left-hander in his mid-thirties. Both bring experience, but recent trends point in different directions. This analysis compares their results across run prevention, command, and overall value, with four figures included to highlight the key differences.

Run Prevention and Peripherals

Pitcher A has been more consistent at limiting runs, averaging a 3.02 ERA and 147 ERA+ over four seasons. Pitcher B averaged 3.36 ERA and 128 ERA+, though with more innings pitched. **Figure 1 (Run Prevention & Peripherals)** shows ERA alongside defense-independent metrics. Pitcher A regularly outperformed expectations, while Pitcher B was more volatile; excellent at age 32 (ERA 2.44, ERA+ 171), but below average at 33 before partial recovery at 34.

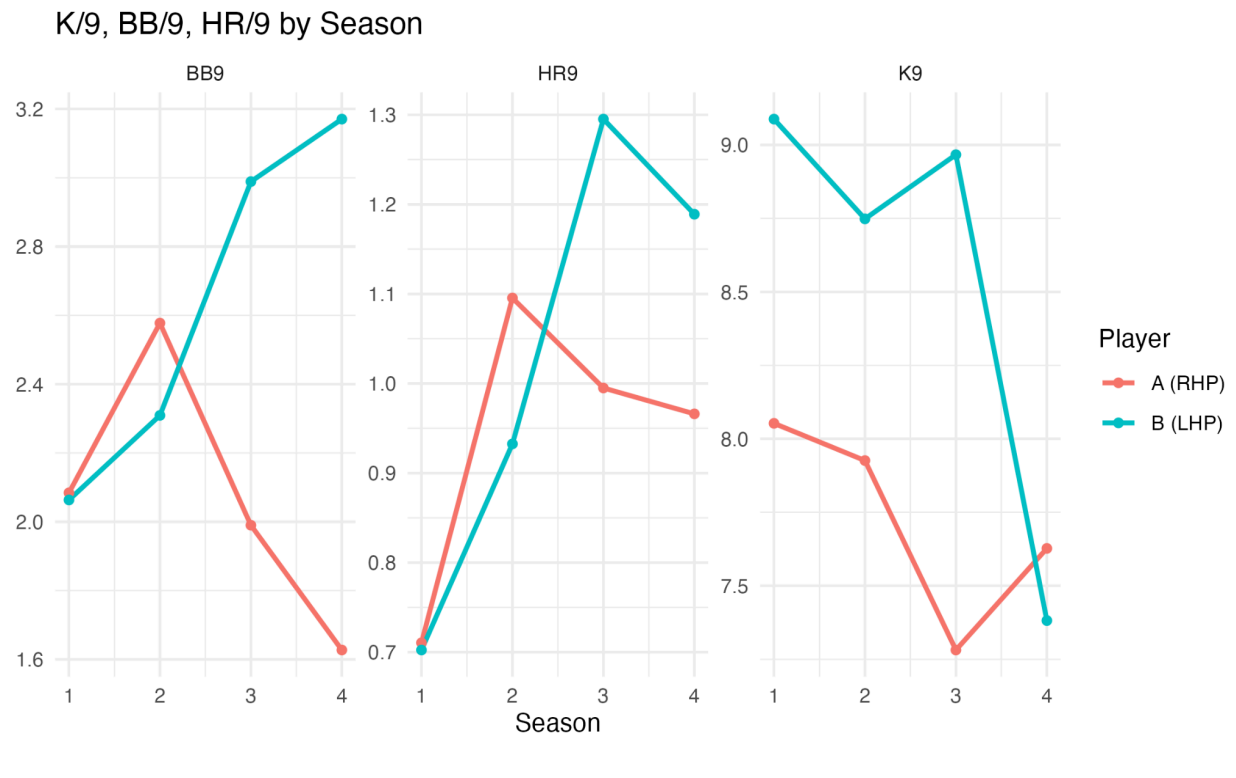
Figure 1 (Run Prevention & Peripherals)



Strikeouts, Walks, and Home Runs

Pitcher B recorded more strikeouts (733 vs 604), but also more walks (223 vs 160). **Figure 2 (K/9, BB/9, HR/9)** illustrates this trade-off: B's strikeout rates are higher, but his walk rate trends upward in later seasons. Pitcher A maintains steadier command and allows fewer home runs overall, balancing effectiveness with efficiency .

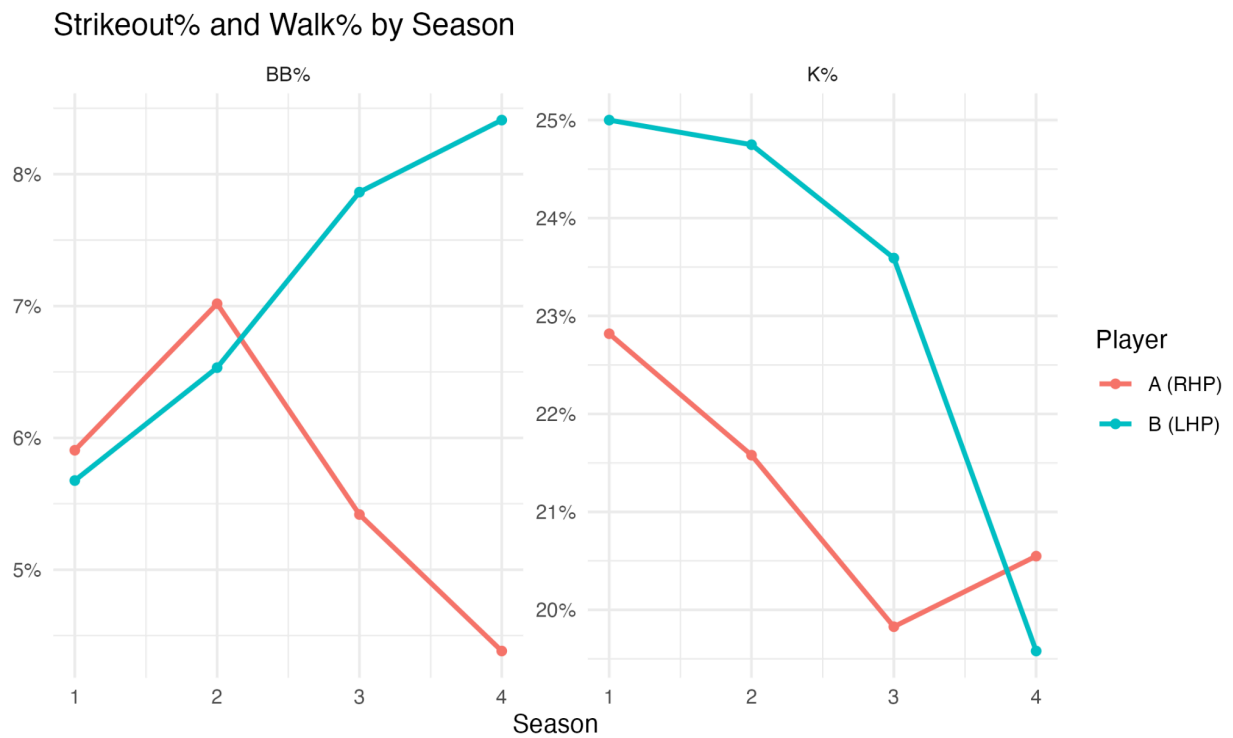
Figure 2 (K/9, BB/9, HR/9)



Command Profile

When looking at percentages relative to batters faced, **Figure 3 (K% and BB%)** shows Pitcher A pairing solid strikeout rates with low walk rates each season. Pitcher B's strikeout ability remains evident, but his rising walk percentage after age 32 highlights eroding control. For an older pitcher, this is a concerning trend.

Figure 3 (K% and BB%)



Overall Value

In cumulative terms, Pitcher A leads with 14.2 fWAR, 16.0 bWAR, and 12.5 WARP versus Pitcher B's 13.8, 12.0, and 10.9. **Figure 4 (WAR by Season)** reinforces the contrast: Pitcher A delivered strong WAR totals in three of four years, while Pitcher B peaked in his age-32 season but declined in both subsequent years .

Figure 4 (WAR by Season)



Age and Trajectory

Age magnifies the difference. Pitcher A's sample spans ages 26–29, typically a pitcher's prime, with no evidence of decline and improved walk control at 29. Pitcher B's data covers ages 31–34, with a clear downward trajectory since his peak. Walk totals and ERA have trended higher, and WAR has fallen each year since age 32. While a left-hander brings roster balance, the age curve suggests his best years are behind him.

Recommendation

Both pitchers bring value: Pitcher B offers durability, strikeout upside, and the utility of a lefty arm, while Pitcher A delivers steadier run prevention, fewer walks, and higher WAR totals. Considering age, consistency, and long-term projection, **Pitcher A is the stronger choice**. He is entering his prime and has not shown decline, while Pitcher B is already trending downward. For a rotation spot meant to provide sustainable performance, the safer and more effective option is Pitcher A.